A large number of rock settlements were built in response to the economic and political growth. These were enormous and made by the peasants for the king and the elite. Therefore, there were sophisticated workplaces to design and conduct trades such as blacksmithing. This type of construction became characteristic of the city as people began to create more and more buildings using these rocks. The building with stones was inherited from the Mapungubwe. The construction of imposing stone buildings reached its climax in the Kingdom of Zimbabwe. They mainly used granite to build with stones as this kind of rock predominates in the region.

Consequently, the Great Zimbabwe Monument was constructed with granite as well. The method they used to build involved dry-stone walling, which demanded a high level of masonry expertise. Also, much of the site of the Great Zimbabwe Monument was based on round natural rock formations and had an enclosing wall of 20 meters in height. Inside this monument, there are passages that are concentric along with some enclosures. One of them is thought to be the royal enclosure where large quantities of gold and arms could once be found.

Regarding the economy, the kingdom controlled gold and ivory trade from the southern coast of Africa. Great Zimbabwe was the center of an international trading system that encompassed many places in Africa and Asia. Because the people had an adamant web of trading, Asian and Arabic goods could be found easily in the kingdom. The principal economic activity was derived from having gold, copper and iron but the people also kept livestock and possessed other small businesses. As a result, most of the kingdom’s wealth came from cattle production and gold. The mines from which they extracted the gold were located more than 40 kilometers away from Great Zimbabwe. Some speculate that rather than having direct control over the mines, the people from Zimbabwe managed to trade cattle for large amounts of gold.

By 1200, the city was established and became well-known as a religious and trading center. Some say that religion played a crucial part in the kingdom’s rise to power. Historians believe the tall tower was used to worship their gods. The people from Zimbabwe believed in the Shona